



COODU TRUST

ANNUAL REPORT



2003-2004

Director with District Collectors and Officials



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Thiru R. Venkatesan I.A.S., - Collector, Kanchipuram



Thiru. P. Annamalai I.A.S., - Collector, Karur



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Dr. P. Chandramohan I.A.S., - Collector, Madurai



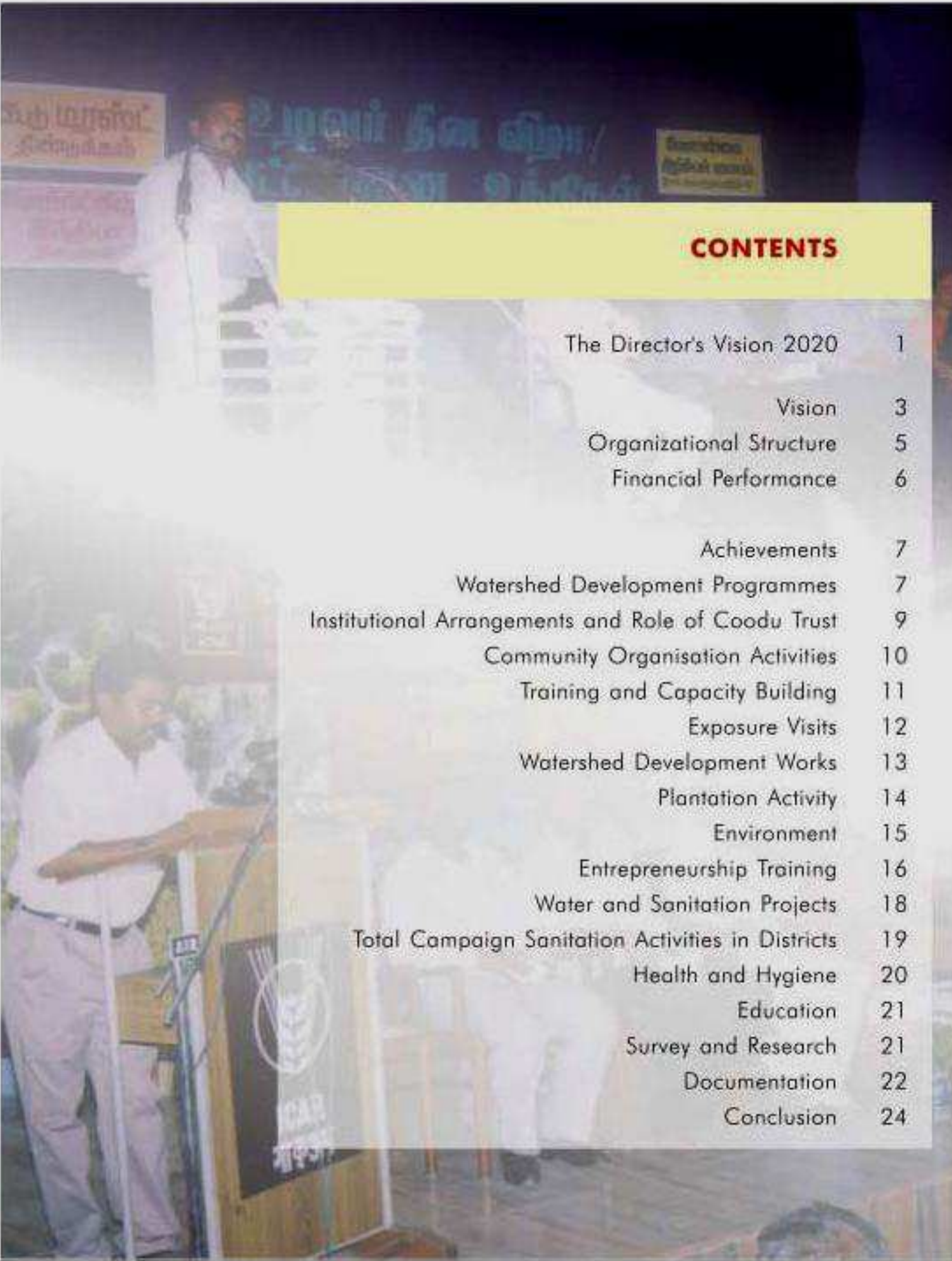
Thiru. Sunil Paliwal I.A.S., - Collector, Tirunelveli



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... the Director's vision **2020** ...

It is with great pleasure that I inform you of the tremendous changes that are transforming the socio-economic Landscape of the state through the determined efforts of our organisation - COODU TRUST - that has been growing from strength to strength with every passing year. The highlight of the year's programme was a brief meeting we (around 70 members from Karur district) had with His Excellency, Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, President of India, who wished us success on our journey of Growth and Development.

In tune with its vision of 'Creating an Egalitarian, self-reliant society adopting latest technological advances through the participatory approach, Coodu Trust has contributed to transformation in society by empowering people, binding them through structured institutional arrangements, enabled them to learn and adopt measures to increase productivity from assets that were considered unproductive. I sincerely hope that the Trust is able to carry the torch forward toward realising the objectives of 'Vision 2020'. It is heartening to note that the initiatives of the Trust are reaching out to the poorest of the poor, the marginalized, the asset-less discriminated communities(SC/ST) and women.

The sustained efforts of the Trust's focus on agriculture and allied activities as a major chunk of its activities revolve around agriculture have paid rich dividends in terms of bringing several thousand hectares in Tamil Nadu, spread over several large districts under the plough, raising plantations, undertaking allied activities as Livestock development, Development of rural economy through proper planning, Group formations and Stress on savings. The Participatory approach has been key to the success of the initiatives of the organisation with its focus on improving the quality of life of 'the last man in the last row'.

In terms of changing individual lives, Coodu Trust has provided the much-needed skills - imparted through series of skill-development programmes. These programmes have tremendously influenced women in the target villages- having acquired the nuances of leadership, team-building, motivation and conflict-resolution. Besides, these women have also been given Formal training in financial and Administrative Management and running of registered bodies. Many women have benefited from the programmes offered by the Trust Empowering them to participate in local Panchayati Raj Institutions.

Another path-breaking achievement has been the formation and strengthening of SHGs throughout the project areas. Women members of the SHGs have been able to multiply their economic assets through planned, sustained economic activities and savings. What is more interesting is that they are able to increase capital through investments in various commercially viable ventures, thus ranking in profits.

The multi-pronged approach of Coodu Trust involves providing training and building capacities of Individuals, Groups and the Community on one hand as well as establishing and strengthening forward and backward linkages through inter-sector





network of Government institution, financial institution such as banks, cooperatives and non-institutional funds. Backed with professional training through Entrepreneurship Development Programmes, women SHGs especially have harnessed resources to the maximum extent possible so far while potential for growth continues to be generated. The different EDP programmes held for beneficiaries through the Trust include training on Mushroom cultivation, Nursery/ raising plantation, paper cups manufacture, Vermi- composing, Beautician course, Computer training for unemployed youth, mainly girls.

With the objective of Integrated Development especially in rural areas where agriculture and allied activities are undertaken on a massive scale, the Trust has also embarked on the centrally- sponsored water and sanitation schemes, implementing the Total Sanitation Campaign aimed at overall improvement in village sanitation through diverse activities- imparting information and improving knowledge and awareness on health and hygiene, construction of Individual Household Latrines(IHHL) in all target Panchayats, school sanitation programme, Waste Water Management, Solid Waste Management pointing at developing a sustainable environment.

In the digital era, no efforts can be complete without an accent on Information Technology. Coodu Trust realised this early and has made significant advancements through an in-house developed Management Information System, use of latest software and operating platforms for rapid data entry and analysis as well as harnessing the full power of the net. Latest trends, information and experiences are applied through analysis of successful lessons learned by the Trust as well as others in various fields, always trying to adopt best practices in the field.

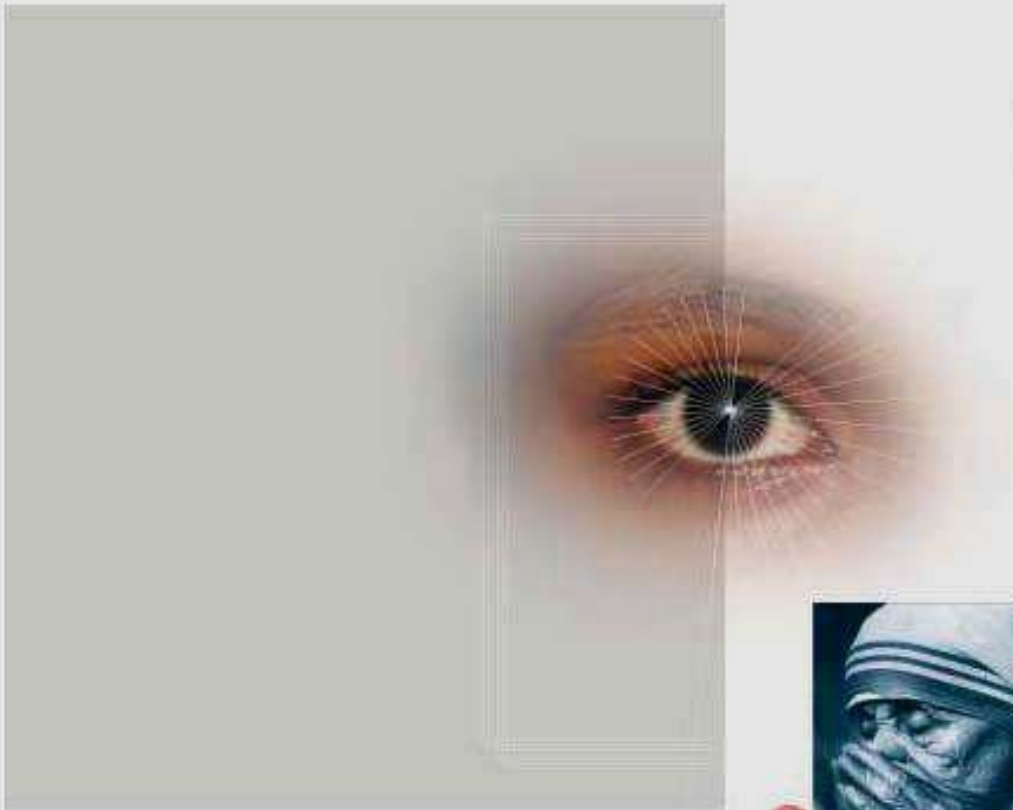
Coodu Trust has also set up excellent infrastructure for documenting several projects through latest, digital audio-visual equipment and facilities. It has post- production editing and multimedia expertise and produced land - mark material covering various state and central and programmes.

To recap the extent and depth of activities of the Trust during 2003- 2004, it may be concluded that significant milestones have been crossed, with increase in standard of living among the target beneficiaries in all programmes - Watershed, Sanitation, Health, Livestock and Animal Health, Training, Entrepreneurship Development, Education and those affecting all walks of life of the common people. Impact assessment studies have indicated a qualitative improvement in the lives of women, marginalized and SC/ST communities, owing to the thrust of the organisation- both by garnering financial support as well as professional managerial inputs and latest technical know-how.

Yet, Coodu Trust strongly believes that it cannot rest on past laurels as there is potential for further growth and until the daunting task of reaching every person in need of help is reached and provided with sustained development alternatives.

S.JAGADEESAN

Director
COODU TRUST, Dindigul.



Vision

"Creating an egalitarian, self-reliant society by adopting latest and appropriate technologies sustained through participatory community efforts"

Mission Statement

The Mission of the Trust is to create an egalitarian society with a view to reducing disparity between classes through a gender-based and human rights approach. The Trust also seeks to create a self-reliant society by harnessing the full power of Information Technology and Enhancing productivity, speed, Accountability and hence, overall efficiency in Project Management. It also seeks to build relationships within communities by adopting participatory methods, ensuring that the benefits of development reach 'the last man in the last row'.



Genesis and Growth

COODU TRUST emerged on the motivation of a few young and dynamic like-minded persons and professionals who pledged to do something for the underprivileged of the society. The name 'Coodu' signifies 'Nest' - a place of rest, comfort and security for those in search of the same. This is a not-for-profit voluntary organization to undertake charitable, educational and development activities for the welfare of downtrodden and marginalized people of society, including women and children. With humble beginnings in four districts, Coodu Trust's activities directly cover more than half the number of districts and has effected programmes throughout the state of Tamil Nadu.

Organizational Structure

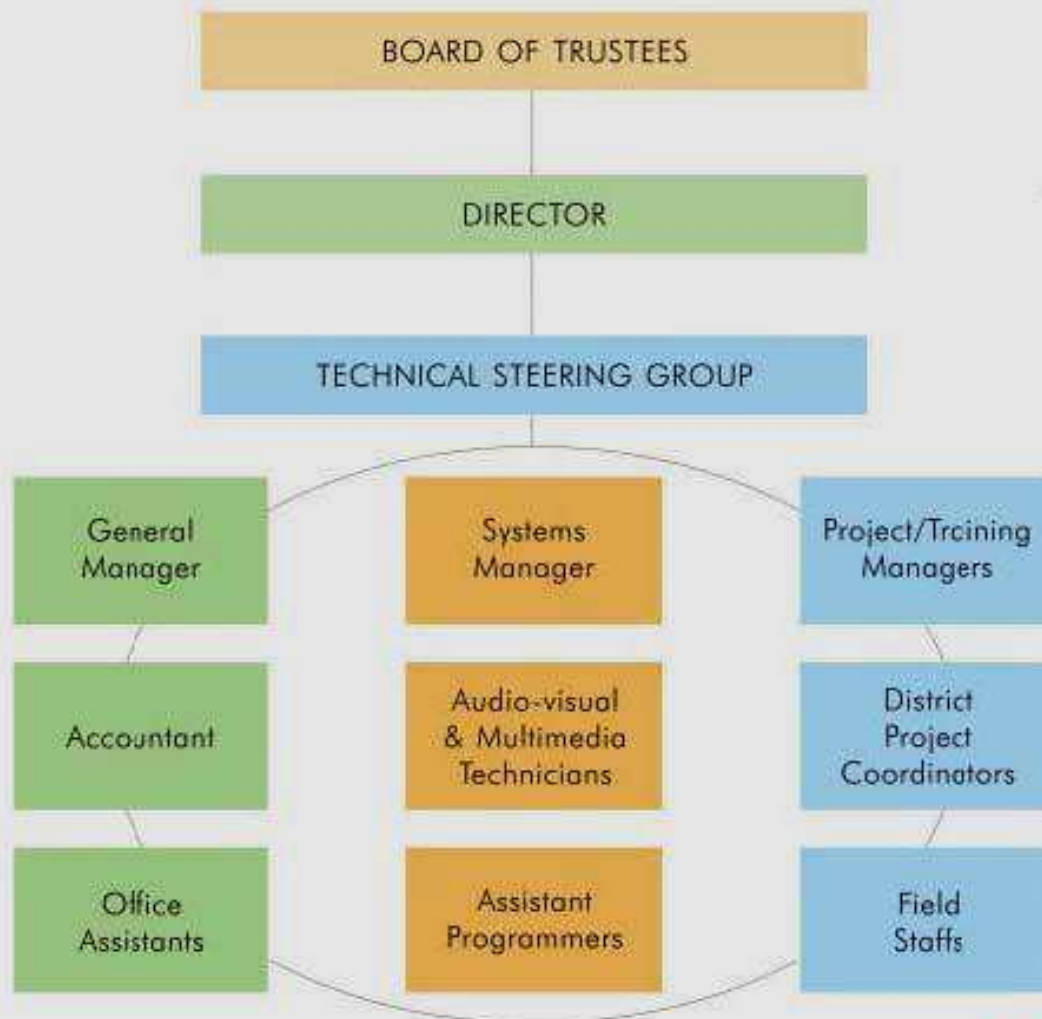
Coodu Trust has a rather flat organizational structure with the Founder Director in charge of the overall functioning of the Trust and answerable to the Board of Trustees that meet periodically to assess and chalk the future strategy of the organization. There are mainly four key divisions- Project Division with staff structure in all districts, Training Division undertaking programme training as well as skill-based vocational and entrepreneurship training. The administrative division manages personnel and overall project coordination at headquarters. The IT and audio-visual division undertakes documentation and creates audio-visual materials, CD presentations etc. for Coodu Trust.





COODU TRUST

Organisation Structure





Financial Performance

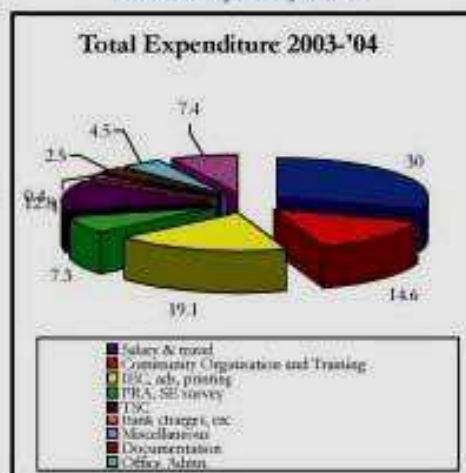
A comparison of the financial statement of the previous year indicate a substantial increase in outlay for various projects being implemented by the Trust and as a result of new projects that have been recorded in Total Sanitation Campaign (TSC) project expenses, vehicle maintenance, office administration and documentation. This also indicates that many of the project cycles have moved from initial awareness generation and training to implementation of other long-term project components.

Consolidated Expenditure Statement for 2003-2004

Sl. No.	Expenditure particulars	Amount (Rs.)
1.	Salary and travel	22,93,779.00
2.	Community Organisation and Training	11,10,083.00
3.	IEC, advertisements, designing & printing	14,61,245.00
4.	Evaluation, Socio-economic/Benchmark survey	5,57,320.00
5.	Total Sanitation Campaign (TSC)	9,77,071.00
6.	Bank charges, audit fees, etc.	95,215.00
7.	Miscellaneous expenses	27,782.00
8.	Documentation	1,90,626.00
9.	Office administration	3,45,222.00
10.	Vehicle maintenance, repairs, etc.	5,78,541.00
	TOTAL	76,36,884.00

Diagram - I

Consolidated Expenditure for 2003-04



ACHIEVEMENTS IN 2003 - 2004



The year 2003 - 2004 can be said to be an important milestone in the annals of Coodu Trust as it was on this year that significant strides have been made in all fields of development, banking on the achievements and laurels the organisation gained over the last three years.

With its innovative policies and programmes, Coodu Trust has been able to influence in policy planning by suggesting positive measures such as increased participatory component on the part of the people, enabling and empowering women through SHGs, motivating women leaders to join mainstream political activities through active involvement in local self - governance - Panchayati Raj institutions at local level. The Trust has also maintained close rapport with senior and middle level functionaries of various state and central government of various departments such as Agriculture, Agricultural Engineering, Horticulture, Forest, Women Development, Education, Health, TWAD Board, Sanitation, Human Resources, Employment and Training and various other line and staff departments.



WATERSHED DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS

During the current year, Coodu Trust has been actively engaged in Watershed Development Projects in nine districts and the coverage of programmes have been under various schemes. A total of 248 watersheds were covered during the year under all schemes. The District - wise coverage programmes covered during 2003 - 04 is described in the following page.



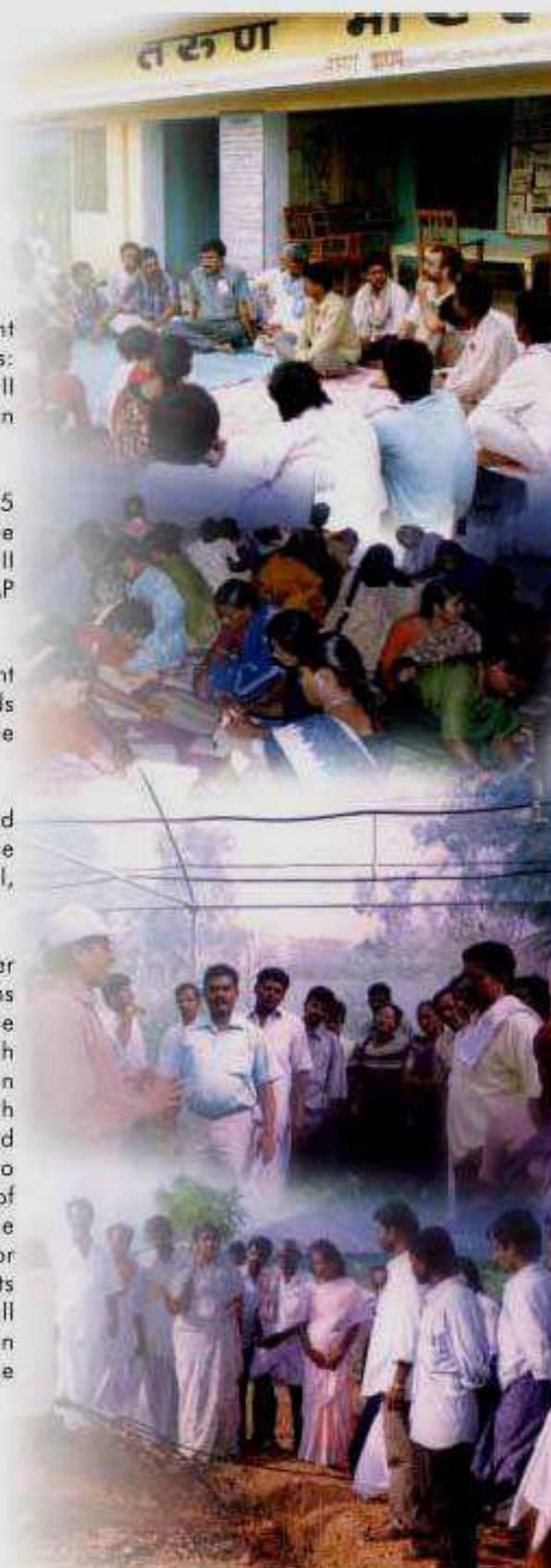
IWDP - Integrated Watershed Development Programmes: Totally 126 watershed in 5 districts: Various batches of IWDP implemented are IWDP - II and III in Dindigul, IWDP - I and II in Karur, IDWP in Madurai, Tirunelveli and Sivagangai districts.

DPAP - Drought Prone Area Programme: Total 55 watersheds in 4 districts: Under DPAP Scheme, the districts covered include: DPAP, Karur, DPAP - VIII and IX batches in Tirunelveli and Salem and DPAP VIII and IX batches in Sivagangai district.

NWDPR - The National Watershed Development Programme for Rainfed Areas: Total 20 watersheds in 2 districts: The district covered under this scheme include Dindigul and Madurai.

TNCWP - Tamil Nadu Comprehensive Watershed Programme: Total 47 watersheds in 5 districts: The TNCWP is implemented by Coodu Trust in Dindigul, Tirunelveli, Theni, Salem and Namakkal districts.

In all the above watersheds, Harvesting of rainwater was taken up, establishing horticulture plantations and improvement of drinking water supplies for the villages were taken up. In addition, through people's empowerment, poverty alleviation programmes were also undertaken through harnessing economic resources, skill - based training to women and formation of Groups to maximise output. Stress was also laid on the use of low - cost technology options and binding the community through institutional arrangements for management of common resources and assets created through the watershed programmes. In all districts, it has been observed that there has been an overwhelming response from the community and the projects has been able to achieve its goals.



Institutional Arrangements and role of Coodu Trust

The project Implementing Agency have been guiding the NGO, Coodu Trust in implementing the programme successfully by providing technical assistance as well as through on - site demonstrations. In several Districts, several PIAs, department of Agriculture, Horticulture, Forests and Environment and Agricultural Engineering have converged to provide the best results. Dindigul district may be considered as one example and also as a 'Model District' provide it to be a 'success story'. In all the watersheds, a watershed Development Team each has been established, that includes an Engineer, a Sociologist, an Agriculturist and a Botanist. The team is deputed by Coodu Trust and supervised by respective PIA. The Village Watershed Committee constituted meets twice at least every year and decides and approves the watershed development plan, monitors and reviews progress periodically, resolves disputes and has formed User Groups/ Area Groups and also Self Help Groups along with the WDT and senior officials of DRDA. Coodu Trust is the coordinating agency and plays a key role in undertaking training and capacity building as well as community mobilisation activities through people's participation.



Community Organisation Activities

The impact of community mobilisation across all districts in the state that have been covered by Coodu Trust has been transformation and permanent. Such activities have evoked greater people's participation, respect for their views and aspirations of each other, sharing experiences and learning lessons from other's positive aspects, building of joint capacity of the people, better community- based planning and finally has enabled the community members realise that they can henceforth work for a common cause. Exposure visits from part of the post-training package where participants get 'first-hand' information on theoretical aspects of watershed in which they were trained.

Conducting Participatory Rural Appraisals in selected villages

As the Participatory Approach has been adopted as key to understanding the rural people's problem as they share common resources, Participatory Rural Appraisals (PRAs) were conducted in all the target villages to determine the topography of the village, soil structure, cropping pattern, rainfall, yield, socio-cultural aspects, economic livelihood of villagers, wealth (income, assets and livestock), seasonality patterns, importance and utilisation of vital services such as health, education, transport and communication and other vital information.

The following tools and techniques or PRA exercises were used to capture information on the village and its population: Transect Walk, Resource Mapping, Social Mapping with table of households, Seasonality Analysis, Venn Diagram, Wealth Ranking, Matrix Ranking, Timeline, SWOT Analysis, Segregation into work components on the basis of problems/ needs, Project Planning and devising Strategy.





Training and Capacity Building

The training component in Watershed programmes is primarily of two types- one training exercise is aimed at equipping project personnel and key stakeholders in improving watershed activities while the other kind of training programmes impart skill training to members to engage in entrepreneurial activities to sustain a living while also benefitting from watershed activities. The training methodology includes a mixed bag of classroom lectures, interactive sessions with farmers, mock exercises, field visits to demonstration farms and research stations, participation in workshops and seminars and practical training, including experimentation. The various Training activities conducted during the year in all the watersheds in the Implementing Districts include the following:-

- Training for Presidents of Watershed Association
- Training for Chairmen of Watershed Committees/ Secretaries/ Volunteers
- Training to Village Panchayat members related to watershed
- Training to office bearers and members of Watershed Committees
- Training to User Groups, Area Groups and SHGs
- Workshop on IWDP with PIA, line departments, NGOs and farmers

The impact of Training activities, as in the case of EPAs and construction of scheme works has been long- lasting, exhibiting a 'ripple' effect with trained members further being able to train others at the grassroots level on basic concepts pertaining to watershed management. The training, with a mix of theory and practice enhanced skills in many participants thereby enhancing their knowledge and awareness on agriculture development and created a model that can be replicated elsewhere given similar conditions.



Exposure Visits

The following exposure visits were conducted during the year to educate Watersheds and obtain first-hand knowledge of various practices that may be replicated back home on their respective watersheds.

16 th July to 24 th July 2003 - by IWDP Vedsandur Block of Dindigul district to Maharashtra, Delhi and Rajasthan. Around 70 members went on this visit from 20 watersheds.

5 th May to 7 th May 2003 - by TNCWP Mannur Block, Tirunelveli district to other Watersheds in northern districts of the state. Around 120 members from 12 watersheds went on this exposure visit.

4 th September to 6 th September 2003 - Sivagangai District to other watersheds in the state in which 128 members went on the exposure visit from 6 watersheds.

16 th September to 18 th September 2003 - by DPAP, Kuruvikulam Block in Tirunelveli District to other Watersheds in Northern Districts of the state. Around 120 members from 7 watersheds went on this exposure visit.

1 st April to 12 th April 2004 - by IWDP Kadavur Block in Karur District in which 460 members from 23 watersheds went on an exposure visit to agricultural research stations.

7 th April to 9 th April 2004 - by IWDP Thathaiyergarpettai Block in Trichy District to other watersheds in the state. Above 240 members went on this visit from 12 watersheds.

19 th April to April 2004 - by IWDP Kadavur Block in Karur district to Maharashtra, Delhi and Rajasthan. Around 70 members went on this visit from 23 watersheds.



Indian Agriculture Research Institute-Delhi



Kuppam Tsraile Technology - Andhra Pradesh



Rajasthan - Dharun Bharath Singh



Andhra Pradesh - Kuppam area development agency



Maharashtra - Ralegan Sidhi with Shri. Anna Hazare



Watershed Development Works

The Watershed Development project was implemented in all the sanctioned districts through the participatory approach, using fully the local wisdom and based on the perceived and prioritised needs of the people. In this manner many of the watershed development works were done using locally available materials, yet adhering to strict quality norms.



The implementation of the programmes at the grassroots level was done through the formation of watershed Development Committees and other institutional structures at the village level with technical know-how from the PIA and coordinating NGO through training and orientation on various aspects pertaining to watershed development. The following activities have been undertaken in all the districts with the resulting impact under various schemes:



Rain Water Harvesting through open wells, development of small water harvesting structures as low - cost farm ponds, nullah bunds, check dams, percolation tanks. The impact of such activities is a reduction in runoff rain water in open fields, increase in water level in wells and open structures, increase in ground water level, increase in area under cultivation and curbing of top soil erosion.



Renovation and de-silting of tanks/ponds, augmentation of water sources. This has resulted in filling irrigation gap, increase in water storage capacity, dry land cultivation being brought under wet land cultivation, conversion from single crop area to double crop area, increase in water in nearby wells and in tank itself. (2-3 times)

Social forestry and orchard plantations. While afforestation has lead to increase in green cover and improvement in the ecosystem, the planting of orchards has brought more wastelands under plantation with an increase in intercrop area.

Herbal cultivation in open lands with adequate moisture content in soil. The advantages of such innovative farming are many. While more wasteland has been brought under cultivation, farmers have obtained additional income and there is a revival of knowledge of herbs and traditional

systems of medicine. The most significant advantage is the appreciation of land value under herbal cultivation.

Land development and reclamation including in-situ soil and moisture conservation measures. Principally activities undertaken include reclamation of degraded and undulated wastelands to level land through land levelling thereby brought under cultivation with earthen bunding on sides. This has controlled soil erosion, lead to increase in moisture retention capacity, increased wasteland brought under cultivation, conversion of dry land to wet land, increase in production and subsequent increase in land value indicating increase in income.

Minor/ major/ diversion check dams and stone bunding structures. These minor civil structures made of locally available materials helps in arresting top soil erosion as they are laid in slopes with over 10 percent gradient. As a result of such measures, there is increase in moisture retention in catchment areas, increase in production, conversion of wasteland into cultivable land and additional vegetative cover.

Plantation Activity

The following plantation activities have been carried out in the different Districts in the state under Tamil Nadu Comprehensive Wasteland Programme per the details given below:

Dindigul district, Nilakkottai Block: 1420 hectares

Tirunelveli district, Mannur Block: 1696.00 hectares

Namakkal district, Erumaipatty Block: 2050.00 hectares

Salem district, Tharamangalam and Kolathur Blocks: 3200.00 hectares

Theni district, Andipatti Block: 1380.00 hectares

Other Development works implemented in various Districts included the following activities:

Summer ploughing, Percolation Ponds and Bore-well digging

Mushroom cultivation, Vermi-composting and demonstration

Fodder Development and Post-project Management





ENVIRONMENT

Rainwater Harvesting Training

The value of water can never be undermined. Not under the present context of scarce and depleting ground as well as surface water sources. To augment knowledge and awareness on need to conserve every drop of water, Coodu Trust has been in the forefront in all Districts where it is active in professing the importance to preserve and harvest every drop of precious rain water. Training on Rain Water Harvesting techniques in open farms, open surface ponds and in houses and buildings in rural and urban areas is provided to all project beneficiaries, SHGs, farmers and the general public. This has reaped rich benefits by way of proven increase in ground water table by way of recharge of ground aquifers. Technical know-how on various methods to save rainwater are provided to different target groups.



Conservation of Medicinal plants

Medicinal plants are of great commercial value as plant extracts are used for manufacture of medicines. The effectiveness of traditional systems of medicines have wide and far-reaching effects and herbal medicines are today finding their way into the international export market. Coodu Trust has realised the potential of cultivating medicinal plants on large scale through establishment of herbal garden on commercial level. Thus, the Trust has been providing training to women groups, small and marginal farmers and others. This is done through conducting of series of Training Workshops on cultivation of medicinal plants endemic to the Western Ghats held in various Districts. Women were especially trained in raising and managing Kitchen Herbal Gardens, women groups were encouraged in establishing Homestead Gardens with technical guidance on agriculture techniques.





ENTREPRENEURSHIP TRAINING

Micro-Finance and Poverty Alleviation

Rural indebtedness is one of the many ills stalking rural societies in the State today and is common in virtually all Districts where the Trust is actively working. The problems of excessive borrowing from greedy money lenders has not escaped the rural poor, especially marginized and SC/ ST women. Widows and women-headed households are more prone to debt traps and it is with the view to release such women from the crutches of indebtedness and poverty motivated Coodu Trust to concentrate its efforts in development of micro-finance and poverty alleviation activities on a large scale. Landless/asset-less women especially are vulnerable to falling into total impoverishment and losing whatever little they may have.

Programmes have been designed around such women with a view to redeem their economic status and thereby improve their social standing in the society. With the emancipation of women-headed households in mind, the Trust has fine-tuned its micro-credit, thrift and savings programmes to suite the needs of these women. Current training and capacity building activities of the Trust involve enhancing Entrepreneurship Development Programmes among women groups with a view to imparting skills training in taking up commercially viable and sustainable income-generating programmes. Coodu Trust has successfully begun training women entrepreneurs in various dimensions including on leadership, decision making, micro-finance and in undertaking Income Generating programmes.

SHGs Training- Savings, Revolving funds and credit facilities

In all the target Districts, the village Committee, with the assistance of WDT members has formed SHGs among landless poor, agricultural labourers, SC/ST persons and other marginalized women. The SHGs are provided training on micro-finance and encouraged to develop savings, engage in income generating activities and are provided several vocational training for developing skills and establishing trades that enable them to sustain their economic living. The SHG training on credit facilities





highlighted on the importance of savings, operation of bank accounts and obtaining assistance in the form of grants/subsidies from banks/ cooperatives/ other financial institutions, post office savings scheme, small savings, chits, chit funds, transactions with other individuals/ institutions, SHG revolving funds and so on. Following the training, Coodu Trust guided few SHG members to obtain financial assistance through various schemes available.

Mushroom Cultivation Training

Coodu Trust was instrumental in providing Mushroom Cultivation Training to selected women groups in each District in Dindigul, Trichy and Karur Districts.



Nursery and Raising Plantation Training

Selected women groups in Dindigul, Trichy and Karur Districts were trained in Nursery and Raising Plantations as part of sustainable agricultural practice as well as an income generating option for them.



Income Generating Programmes

Women in Trichy district were trained by Coodu Trust in the manufacture of environmentally-friendly 'paper cups' and allied paper products that have good commercial value as well as enhance skill development among the women who are confident of taking up such activities on an entrepreneurial basis.

Vermi-composting and Organic farming training

In Karur and Dindigul Districts, agriculturists and farmers in watersheds were identified and provided training in vermi-composting and organic farming techniques that would enhance the fertility of the soil, prevent degradation due to chemicals and inorganic methods and help increase crop yield productivity.



Beautician Course Training

Through the efforts of Coodu Trust, 20 women in Dindigul District were selected and trained in Beautician Course for 3 months with a view that they undertake Entrepreneurship activities on their own. This task was realised through the

Women Development Corporation, Government of Tamil Nadu.

Computer Training and Data Entry for Unemployed youth and girls

In Dindigul District, Coodu Trust provides Computer Training following by jobs in data entry for educated, unemployed youth and girls. They are engaged in BPL (Below Poverty Line) Survey data entry, TSC (Total Sanitation Campaign) computerisation and other similar projects from time to time.

Around 20 educated unemployed girls are employed frequently by jobs done for various departments of the state Government.

WATER AND SANITATION PROJECTS

TOTAL SANITATION CAMPAIGN

The scope of activities under Total Sanitation Campaign include the view of Water and Sanitation status in target and devise measures to reduce mortality/ morbidity due to such water-related diseases, undertake various activities under TSC include construction of individual household latrines the establishment and managing of Rural Sanitary Mart that would supply hardware sanitary materials for construction of toilets, construction and supervision of Village Sanitary Complex for Women, up-gradation of Rural Sanitary Latrines, construction of School Toilets and school sanitation awareness programme, construction of Baby-Friendly Toilets and toilets for Angawadi centres, Waste Water Management, Solid Waste Management, reduction of Pollution in the villages and integrated environmental protection and development.

The TSC also includes conduct of Awareness generation programmes establishing Institutional Arrangements for the water and sanitation programme networking with NGOs, enlisting Block level and Panchayat level support, Management Training and coordinating with local political leadership, women's groups and involving children through school sanitation programme.





The Training component involves training on the knowledge of good water supply and the importance of sanitation, health and toilet maintenance, IEC campaigns - Motivational campaigns, advocacy skits, motivation, etc., door-to-door campaigns, mass education organising 'kala jathas', street plays, etc., preparation of exhibition materials, pamphlets, booklets, etc., environmental sanitation includes - Waste Water Management, and Solid Waste management, awareness on pollution on sanitation system, financial procedures, construction procedures and maintenance procedures, Crafts and management training procedures, documentation procedures, training to panchayat water and sanitation committee members and training on monitoring and evaluation.

The Impact assessment component included undertaking assessment of the impact of sanitation projects in the community through multi-efforts across various institutions.

Total Sanitation Campaign Activities in the Districts

In **Dindigul** District, Nilakkottai Block TSC activities were taken up and soon after awareness campaigns and community mobilisation and training activities were completed, in 3 Panchayats of Pachamalayankottai, S.Pudupatty, 135 Individual Household Latrines (IHHL) were constructed and another 200 IHHL were under construction.



In **Karur** District, Kodavur Block (19 Panchayats) the activities that were completed included conducting informal meetings with 1900 participants, Formal meetings and publicity campaigns with 2110 participants, awareness campaigns among 2000 participants. PRA exercises were conducted which involved 4210 members and 2500 members participated in IEC activities. Other important activities involved establishing one Rural Sanitary Mart and construction of 3055 IHHL.



The TSC activities in **Madurai** District were undertaken in 10 Panchayat villages in three Blocks-Kalligudi, T. Kallupatty and Sedapatty and included IEC activities-Awareness Campaigns conducted in 2 panchayats each and Wall



writings in 6 Panchayats each in Thirumangalam and Kalligudi Blocks. This was followed by construction of 1500 IHHL.

In **Trichy** District, TSC programme was taken up in 2 Blocks totally 22 Panchayats. Activities included construction of 265 IHHL in Thathaiyangarpet Block and remaining 375 IHHL in Thuraiyur Block.

The **Tirunelveli** District Total Sanitation Campaign was confined to a single block in Kuruvikulam in 42 Panchayats and activities included 252 Wall writings as part of IEC activities and 84 Awareness Campaigns in all 42 Panchayats. At the close of the year, 1704 IHHL were constructed along with 33 School toilets and 16 Anganwadi toilets.

The TSC had been launched in **Salem** District in Kolathur Block in 22 Panchayats and initial activities included conduct of Awareness Campaigns in all target villages.

In **Sivagangai** District TSC activities were done in Devakottai Block in 3 Panchayats and began with IEC and Awareness Campaigns followed by construction of 151 IHHL and 200 IHHL were under construction.

HEALTH

General Rural Health Camps

Health camps with a team of doctors and medical personnel were organised in the watersheds in several Districts including Dindigul and Karur depending on the need of the people in the region. The beneficiaries included youth, men and women and children, the old and disable. General health check up was done. The respective watershed villages and people with chronic illness or serious complaints were referred to the nearest Health Centre or Government District Headquarters hospital for free treatment. Such camps were received with overwhelming response from the local people who wanted the same to be conducted more frequently and with better service provision such as drugs and medicines and care at their villages.





EDUCATION

In Dindigul District, Coodu Trust has obtained permission from the Tamil Nadu Open University to establish an Information and Study Centre for Graduate, Post Graduate and Diploma level courses including Management Studies and Job-oriented Courses. The Centre is functioning at the Coodu Trust Headquarters in Dindigul at H-83, R.M. Colony, DINDIGUL - 624 001.

The Trust is also supporting 300 students hailing from very poor families by providing books and notebooks every year. The same is obtained by generous donors of Coodu Trust and philanthropists engaged in such noble tasks. The aim is to increase and reach out to as many students as possible.

SURVEY AND RESEARCH

Coodu Trust has established an exclusive Survey and Research division specialising in technical quantitative and qualitative surveys in diverse fields - ranging from geographical survey to social and behavioural survey. It has a pool of experts drawn from different fields with several man years of research and field experience in the fields of Agriculture, Engineering, Horticulture, Forestry, Animal Husbandry, Humanities and Social Sciences, Statistics, to mention a few.

Over the years, the Trust has conducted several empirical studies on the fields in agriculture-related as well as in social research for several departments of the State and Central Government. It assists DRDA and other bodies in framing proposals for further research.

Monitoring and Evaluation - Mid-term Evaluation, End-line Evaluation

Coodu Trust has undertaken Mid-term Evaluation and Final Evaluation of various watershed projects under different schemes in Dindigul, Sivagangai districts.

Performance Report for IWDP, Dindigul, Madurai Districts.

Mid-term Evaluation Study conducted for IV and V batch, Sivagangai District.

Socio-economic and Benchmark Surveys

Socio-economic and baseline Benchmark Surveys are conducted during the preliminary stages of the project that



help in determining the socio-economic status of the project area as well as set a standard to enable drawing comparisons over time. The same is also useful for triangulation with other research methods such as review of secondary sources and qualitative or participatory research exercises.

Soil and Land Survey

In collaboration with research institutes and Krishi Vigyan Kendra and department of Agricultural Engineering, Soil Survey studies have been conducted in several Districts to gauge suitability of water holding capacity, fertility, crop preferences, yield, etc.

IT AND MULTIMEDIA

Besides using the latest software and good Management Information Systems for monitoring and evaluating programmes, the Information and Technology division of Coodu Trust has produced landmark CDs and presentations for DRDA, Government of Tamil Nadu and for presentations to World Bank, among others. The following materials have been produced in various districts by the IT division of Coodu Trust:

IEC Materials production and dissemination

IEC materials in Tamil were produced mainly in Dindigul, Tirunelveli, Trichy, Sivagangai, Salem, Namakkal, Theni, Karur and Madurai Districts.

The following materials were printed/ published in several Districts:

Dindigul District:

- “Towards Re-greening: the Shanarpatty Experience”, multi-colour booklet
- Rainwater Harvesting Booklets and Brochures,
- Printing of bi-lingual brochures for CM visit
- Printing of Beneficiaries List for all programmes for CM visit.
- Printing of Multi-colour, bi-lingual brochures and booklet of all schemes under DRDA Dindigul.
- Documenting Shanarpatty Block T50 IHHL under Central Rural Sanitation Programme.





Printing of Calendars/ Diaries

IEC material in Tamil for all projects of DRDA in District

Karur District

Performance Report for IWDP, Kadavur

Printing of Multi-colour, bi-lingual brochures and booklets of all schemes under DRDA Karur.

Trichy District

BPL Survey Computerization for Laigudi Union for the year 2003.

Multicolour brochures for DRDA Scheme Works.

2002 Calendar and Diary printing for IWDP Scheme

T.S.C. - Posters, Stickers, Booklets.

Theni District

WDT Members Training Programme for all Blocks

Multicolour brochures for all DRDA projects

Multicolour brochures for TNCWP Scheme

Salem District

Namakkal District

Kolli Hill-Senthamangalam Project Proposal for IWDP

'Green Impact' documentation for DPAP (2002-03)

Multimedia presentations

The following multimedia related activities were undertaken in the Districts mentioned:

Rainwater harvesting, Dindigul District - CD presentation

World Bank Team visit to Dindigul District Watersheds - CD presentation

Total Sanitation Campaign, Dindigul District - CD presentation

Model Village Documentary Film for S. Gopalapuram Village, Madurai District

Central Team visit for Drought in Tamil Nadu - CD presentation

Conclusion

The Annual Report for the current year indicates that progress has been recorded at all fronts. The organization has grown in strength in terms of capital outlay as well as number of personnel and infrastructure. Additional funds have been obtained for new projects and more professional people (postgraduates/engineers/experienced community organizers and professional social workers) were inducted into the regular rolls of the organization. In terms of organizational infrastructure, Coodu Trust today has established fully functioning offices in all the Districts where it is implementing a whole range of socio-economic development programmes in rural and urban areas. The offices are manned by administrative staff, with requisite number of vehicles, computers and other minimum office equipment, including communication facilities.

The Watershed Development Programmes are the backbone of the organization. The various projects include IWDP, DPAP, TNCWP and NWDPA. While in some Districts, Awareness campaigns, IEC activities and motivation and Entry Point Activities are being carried on, in other Districts, training and capacity building activities are being carried out such as training to watershed members, UG/AG and SHGs. In still other districts, community mobilisation activities are on in full swing motivating them to undertake watershed development works such as construction of stone bunds, summer ploughing, plantation activities and so on. In order to garner maximum number of people in the watersheds, participatory exercises were adopted to forge strong bonds between the people and obtain correct information about the resources, issues ailing the village, simultaneously capturing views of the villagers themselves on ways and means to solve the problems from their own perspective.

Significant strides have also been made in all spheres of developmental activities at the grassroots level in order to realise the objective of holistic development of the village. Thus, the Trust performed exceedingly well in the areas of Water and Sanitation programme implementation through the Total Sanitation Campaign, with a stress on awareness generation and motivation for construction of individual household toilets, school sanitation programme, solid and waste water management aimed at total sustainable environmental development.

With respect to improvements on the economic front among the poor and marginalized, especially women, Coodu Trust has empowered women to be economically independent through inculcating the habits of savings, thrift and micro-finance ventures through appropriate training and linkages with financial institutions. Training in skill development and motivation through leadership and personality development programmes has resulted in women undertaking successful entrepreneurial ventures. This apart, Coodu Trust has made inroads into virtually every sphere of development such as Health - through organising mobile health camps in the target areas, education programmes and vocational training and guidance followed by employment opportunities to educated unemployed youth.

Finally, the research and analysis division of the Trust has produced various landmark studies and analyses of various projects in different Districts for state and centrally sponsored schemes. These include Midterm Evaluation Studies, End-Line Surveys, besides Socio-economic Surveys and Benchmark Surveys in all Districts where Watershed and sanitation Programmes are being carried out. Further, the Trust has also made impressive CD presentations, multi-colour brochures and pamphlets of various activities in different Districts, created inhouse by its audio-visual and multimedia division.

Thus, Coodu Trust has established itself as a dynamic, pioneering organization undertaking watershed and other socio-economic development programmes throughout the state of Tamil Nadu. This has been possible by disintegrating each component of the Vision and Mission and working in tandem with people at the local level through focussed interventions. Similarly, each project is reviewed through a rigorous monitoring and evaluation mechanisms using identified, measurable, reliable, accurate and tangible performance indicators.

The Trust is proud of its achievements in all fields it has ventured into yet it understands that what it has achieved is just 'a drop in the ocean'. However, but for that drop, 'the ocean will be less of that drop' and hence has to continue work in right earnestness, bearing in mind the needs of the poorest of the poor.

Coodu Trust thanks to all its well-wishers, Government of India and Tamil Nadu, philanthropists and donors for their unrestrained support with whose benevolence it continues to serve the people of this country.

Director with District Collectors and Officials



Thiru. N. Muruganantham I.A.S., - Collector, Karur



Thiru. Dhanaavel I.A.S., - Collector, Tirunelveli



Thiru. Atul Anand I.A.S., - Collector, Theni



Dr. Vijayakumar I.A.S., - Secretary, T.N. Govt.



Thiru. P.M. Basheer Ahamed I.A.S., - Collector, Theni



Thiru. Sethu Ramschndran, I.A.S., - Collector, Madurai



Thiru. V. Pandian I.A.S., - Collector, Trichy



Managing Director, TWDA & Director of Horticulture

Foot steps of Coodu Trust at Tamilnadu



Director of
Coodu Trust
Mr. S. Jegadeesan
discussion with
Shri. Anna Hazare
(Father of
Watershed Development
Programme)

- Watershed Development Project has been co-ordinated by Coodu Trust in 11 Districts at Tamilnadu.
- Documentation works has been successfully done by Coodu Trust in all places of Tamilnadu.